



Snapdragon Galaxy S20 FE

The Snapdragon variant of the Samsung Galaxy S20 FE is coming to India to compete with the OnePlus 9. <http://dgit.in/apr21-37>



Google backs Indian startup DotPe

One-year-old Gurgaon-based startup DotPe has raised \$27.5 million in its Series A financing round. <http://dgit.in/apr21-38>

B&O Beoplay A9 4th Gen

Not your ordinary premium speaker

We have used many smart speakers over the years, but we recently received the Bang & Olufsen BeoPlay A9 4th gen that changed the way we look at smart speakers. You can't compare it to the Google Home and Amazon Echo speakers because of their size, audio quality, purpose and price. The BeoPlay A9 4th Gen costs ₹2,50,000 in India, and that immediately cuts off the scope of comparison with most smart speakers. So in this review, we'll talk more about its experience, and if the audio performance justifies the price.

DESIGN

The BeoPlay A9 is one of the most unique-looking speakers. Its uniqueness makes it eye-catching. It looks like a piece of modern art with minimalism all around. The speaker has two major parts - the circular speaker panel and the wooden legs. Assembly is straightforward, you just have to screw three beautiful oak wood legs into the body. The front is covered in a wool-like fabric circled with a chrome ring resting on oak wood legs. The downside of the white variant (which we got) was evident right after we unboxed it, one of the visitors at home touched it and immediately left a dirty thumbprint. It's tough to clean, and you can replace the cover, but it's another 50 Euros (approx ₹4,300), so getting a darker variant might be a better idea.

AUDIO PERFORMANCE

The BeoPlay A9 packs 2 x 3/4-inch tweeters, 2 x 1 1/2-inch full-range driver units, 2 x 3-inch midrange driver unit and an 8-inch woofer. The woofer is powered by a heavy 160-watt amplifier. The total power output of all these drivers combine to offer 480 watts, which is massive for a house of any size. So, the first thing to tick off the list is the loudness, if that's something you worry about. Apart from the glass-



Price
₹4,99,949

shaking loudness, there's a lot more impressive engineering packed inside. It has an Active Room Compensation feature that is advertised to adapt the audio output as per space. We did find the feature working as we shifted the speaker to different rooms.

In terms of the quality of audio, the BeoPlay A9 shines again. If you like your bass warm, filling and powerful, you will love this. More so because it is clean and doesn't dampen the mids and highs, even at high volumes. We played *The Lemon Song* by *Led Zeppelin*, and the experience was just as good as expected. It does, however, struggle with high frequency when the volume crosses 90 percent. Mids and highs like vocals, guitar riffs at normal volume sound beautiful. The soundscape is deep and open, so you will have full sound no matter which room it is placed in. Additionally, you get to tweak the equaliser as per your preference using the companion app.

Apart from music, we paired it with my TV to watch movies and we realised it's a perfect replacement for a

soundbar, although not the best one for directional sound.

CONNECTIVITY

For a premium speaker, we expect all the popular connectivity options to be available. The highlight is that the speaker comes with a built-in Chromecast for Android devices and Apple AirPlay 2 support. It also has DLNA in case you need a tethered connection apart from Bluetooth, Aux and Wi-Fi. Although, these options might suffice for most users, not including NFC and HDMI was a bummer for us. The only connectivity issue we faced during our experience was while pairing the speaker on the B&O companion app.

VERDICT

Delivering the verdict for this speaker is rather easy for us as it is hard to find an alternative that fills the space the BeoPlay A9 has created for itself. Also,

at ₹2,50,000, it is not everyone's speaker as it targets those who want a balance of form and functionality that oozes luxury. If you're someone who likes everything top-notch and classy and can spend a small fortune on it, this speaker won't disappoint. It will bring the house down at a party, do

everything a smart speaker does, and can be a replacement to your soundbar while enhancing the decor of your home. However, if audio performance is the only concern and design is secondary, you will find alternatives that are much more affordable.

—Sudhanshu Singh



BUILD AND DESIGN.....	95
FEATURES.....	85
PERFORMANCE.....	90
VALUE.....	80

SPECIFICATIONS

MATERIALS: Wood, Fabric, Aluminium and Plastic | **WEIGHT:** 14.7 kg | **DIMENSIONS:** 70.1 W x 90.8 H x 41.1 D cm | **AMPLIFIER:** 1 x 400 watt class D for bass, 2 x 200 watt class D for midrange, 2 x 200 watt class D for fullrange, 2 x 150 watt class D for treble | **FREQUENCY RANGE:** 33- 23,000 Hz | **MAXIMUM LOUDNESS @1M (SPL):** 100 dB SPL | **BASS CAPABILITY:** 95 dB SPL | **POWER CONSUMPTION:** Typical 23 watts | **BLUETOOTH VERSION:** 4.2 | **Wi-Fi:** Wi-Fi/WLAN 802.11 a/b/g/n/ac (2.4GHz/5GHz) Wi-Fi for high-performance streaming

CONTACT

BANG & OLUFSEN | **PHONE:** +852 5808 2572 | **EMAIL:** Web form | **WEBSITE:** www.bang-olufsen.com/en